knock out India and, according to the maths, if we reach just 126, we will lose the game but we will still advance because we will have a better run rate than New Zealand.

Let's get this done. Shanthakumaran Sreesanth bowls the first over and sprays the first delivery down the leg side for five wides. Graeme confidently clips the fourth ball for four and we're on our way. It's 11–0 after one over. Let's get this done. Everyone is focused amid growing delirium. Let's get this done.

Herschelle is given out LBW off the first ball of the second over, and I walk out to join Graeme. Stay calm, I tell myself. Don't do anything stupid. This is your chance to play a proper innings. I punch my first delivery into the covers for a single. That feels OK. Graeme is facing. He drives, edges and is well caught at slip. Justin Kemp comes in at No. 4, and we are rocking at 12 for two after two overs. Stay calm. Stay calm.

Sreesanth is running in. I am facing. The first ball is quick, swinging in and striking me on the pad. The Indians appeal. I fear it is close. The umpire is unmoved. It's OK. I have survived. The next ball is full. I drive it hard, straight to cover, and there is no run. Move your feet, I tell myself again. Move your feet.

Here comes Sreesanth again. He bowls fast and straight. I'm beaten for pace. I play too late and am again struck on the front pad. The Indians appeal yet again, only much louder this time. Umpire Simon Taufel raises his finger. In a moment of chaos, it's all over. I am out for one, and we are now 12 for three.

When Justin Kemp and Shaun Pollock get out in the sixth over, we have collapsed to 31 for five. Within 33 mad minutes, we have slumped from being in complete control – on course for a fifth straight win, on track to bury our jinx and win the trophy – to the brink of the most dismal elimination.

Back on our bench, I look to my left and to my right. All my teammates